

2001 Kosovo elects its own assembly.

2001 Milosevic arrested; he is extradited to face war crimes tribunal in the Hague, but dies in 2006 before the case ends.

2003 Country adopts Union of Serbia and Montenegro as official title.

2006 Montenegro votes to leave the union with Serbia and become an independent nation.

2007 UN special envoy Martti Ahtisaari recommends almost total independence for Kosovo as a ward of the EU.

2008 Kosovo declares independence from Serbia on February 17.

2008 The pro-EU Democratic party and the nationalist Socialist Party form a coalition government.

2009 Serbia applies to join the euro.

«198–99 The Byzantine Empire
«246–47 The Ottoman Empire
«450–51 War in Yugoslavia

Montenegro



Once part of Yugoslavia, it became the world's 194th independent state in 2006.

1300s Montenegro consists of the small, inland principality of Zeta within Serbia.

1463 Turks complete conquest of former Serbian Empire, leaving only Montenegro semi-independent, under Ivan IV.

1499 Montenegro is placed under Ottoman suzerainty and from 1566 is governed by the prince-bishop of Cetinje.

1696–1735 Under Danilo I, the episcopal succession is made hereditary in the Petrovic-Njegos family, passing from uncle to nephew as the bishops could not marry. In 1715 Danilo I inaugurates a traditional alliance with Russia.

1699 Ottomans recognize Montenegrin independence by the Treaty of Karlowitz, and it is confirmed again in 1799.

1878 Congress of Berlin recognizes Montenegrin independence; Montenegro gains a narrow outlet to the Adriatic.

1910 Nicholas I proclaims himself king.

1913 Gains territory from Ottoman Turkey at end of First Balkan War and now shares a land border with Serbia.

1914 Joins Serbia in World War I against Austria–Hungary but is invaded and occupied in 1915.

1918 National assembly proclaims union with Serbia as part of the Kingdom of the Serbs, Croats, and Slovenes, known from 1929 as Yugoslavia.

1919 Nationalist revolt against a Serbian takeover is suppressed by 1924.

1946 Becomes one of the six republics within the Federal People's Republic of Yugoslavia under Tito's communist leadership, and gains more land along the Dalmatian coast.

1990 Communists retain power in elections as Yugoslavia collapses.

1992 New Federal Republic of Yugoslavia (FRY), consisting of Montenegro and Serbia (with Kosovo and Vojvodina) is formed.

1996 Montenegro severs ties with Serbia and adopts the German mark and, after 2002, the euro, as its currency.

2006 Montenegrins vote in a referendum for independence from Serbia, although the 55-percent threshold is passed by only 2,300 votes.

2008 Applies to join the euro.

«450–51 War in Yugoslavia

Macedonia



A poor former Yugoslav state that has struggled as an independent nation since 1991.

300s BCE First kingdom of Macedonia covers territory now occupied by northern Greece and southern Albania, former Yugoslavia, and Bulgaria. Under Philip II and Alexander the Great, Macedonia expands into the Middle East, but disintegrates after Alexander's death, becoming a Roman province in 146 BCE.

400s CE Slavs occupy Macedonia.

800s Macedonia becomes part of the Bulgarian Empire following two centuries of dispute with the Byzantine Empire.

963 Macedonia forms part of the empire of Samuil, which regains territory from the Byzantines, but collapses in 1018.

1380 Turks occupy Macedonia, which has an ethnic mix of Slavs, Greeks, and Albanians. Turkish rule leads to decline of Christian population through emigration.

1878 Russia's victory over Turkey leads to Bulgarian, Serb, and Greek claims to the remaining Turkish-held Macedonia. Internal Macedonian Revolutionary Organization (VMRO) formed in 1893 calls for "Macedonia for the Macedonians" and a Balkan federation.

1903 Bulgarian insurgents spark an uprising in Macedonia, which is brutally suppressed. Some 1,700 noncombatant Macedonian Slavs are shot by the Turks.

1912–13 Two Balkan wars lead to a new partition of Macedonia between Greece, Bulgaria, and Serbia. At the end of World

War I in 1918, Serbian-held Macedonia becomes part of Yugoslavia.

1924 VMRO manifesto for an autonomous Macedonia leads to a wave of assassinations of opposing federalists by the VMRO. The Yugoslav government crushes the VMRO in 1934.

1941 Germany occupies Yugoslavia. Macedonia is largely occupied by Bulgaria. Communist Partisan leader Tito organizes Macedonian liberation movement.

1946 Macedonia becomes one of the six republics within the Federal People's Republic of Yugoslavia.

1989–90 Multi-party elections held as Yugoslavia collapses.

1991 Independence declared: EU recognition is delayed by Greece.

1993 Macedonia recognized by EU as the Former Yugoslav Republic of Macedonia. Joins UN.

1995 Accord with Greece as it lifts its trade embargo.

1999 Upheaval in Kosovo spills over into Macedonia, a quarter of whose population is Albanian.

2001 Armed insurrection by Albanian militants inside Macedonia seeking greater autonomy leads to involvement of NATO peacekeeping force.

2004 Elections grant more autonomy to predominantly Albanian areas; Macedonia applies to join the EU.

2008 Greece blocks an invitation to Macedonia to join NATO over the country's use of the name "Macedonia," which it claims implies designs on Greek territory.

«96–97 Alexander the Great
«198–99 The Byzantine Empire
«246–47 The Ottoman Empire



Macedonians shatter ceasefire

On June 22, 2001, Macedonia broke an 11-day-old ceasefire with Albanian rebels seeking greater autonomy, shelling alleged insurgent positions such as this mosque in Aracinovo. The conflict ended in September when NATO troops disarmed the rebels.

Kosovo



Albanian-speaking part of Yugoslavia, it won partially recognized independence in 2008.

1180–90 Ottoman Turks defeat Serbs at the Battle of Kosovo Polje.

1912–13 The Balkan Wars end with the recognition of Albanian independence. Most of Kosovo awarded to Serbia.

1946 New Yugoslav constitution confirms Kosovo's status as autonomous region, with limited self-government.

1981 Death of Marshal Tito leads to uncertainty. Riots break out in Kosovo.

1987 The new Serbian leader Slobodan Milosevic leads a rally in Kosovo of Serb nationalists calling for the closer integration of Kosovo into Serbia.

1991 The separatist Kosovo assembly holds a referendum, which votes 99.8 percent for an independent Kosovo.

1998 Clashes between the KLA (Kosovo Liberation Army) and the Serb police lead to a violent crackdown with Yugoslav army forces joining in the repression.

1999 Failure of peace talks. NATO launches air strikes against Yugoslavia. Huge numbers of ethnic-Albanian refugees flee Kosovo. In June, Milosevic agrees to withdraw military forces and a UN-backed force, KFOR, enters Kosovo.

2008 Kosovo declares its independence. It is rejected by Serbia, but recognized by the United States and most of the EU.

2008 Powers transferred from the UN authorities to the Kosovan government.

2010 The International Court of Justice finds Kosovo's 2008 independence was legal under international law.